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GitHub's Spec Kit has spec-driven development spreading faster than any methodology in years, and the pipeline it ships is requirements review in disguise: /constitution for the rules, /specify for the intent, /clarify for the gaps, /plan, /tasks, then code. The usual explanation for the adoption is that agents need structure. That is half of it.

The other half is that software spent forty years failing to make engineers write specs, and everyone blamed discipline. The real problem was readership. A spec written for humans competes with walking over to the human, and it goes stale the week the code moves, so nobody reread one, so nobody wrote one. A spec written for an agent has a reader that executes against it and asks about every empty input the author waved a hand at. Documentation debt was an incentive problem the whole time, and the incentive just flipped.

Vagueness got priced. When the reader is a person, a fuzzy sentence costs a raised eyebrow and a hallway conversation. When the reader is an agent, the same sentence becomes a wrong build, billed in tokens and rework. Teams running /clarify say it turns into a requirements review where nobody has to volunteer to be the annoying one, because the machine asks what happens on the empty input, the timezone boundary, the refund after the trial, and it never gets tired of asking. The annoying one was always the most valuable person in the room. Now that person is a command.

This exposes a bottleneck upstream of everything agents were supposed to fix. Writing the code was cheap to delegate. Deciding what to build had nowhere to go, and now it is the whole bill. The teams feeling agent pain this quarter are not the ones with the wrong model, they are the ones with unstated decisions. The spec was always the artifact where decisions got stated. Agents are the first readers that punish skipping it.

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The hidden queue is the review contract between those steps. Naming the decision owner and carrying the accepted spec forward prevents each handoff from reopening requirements.



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Miro raised \$476M, was valued at \$17.5B four years ago, and just sold to Bending Spoons for roughly 2.3x ARR. Everyone calling it the SaaS bust is missing the more specific math: a 2021 multiple on a work canvas priced a decade of expanding white-collar headcount, one seat per

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